

**CUHK Philosophy Orientation Camp**

**Game Session**

**GAME**

**REPUBLIC BEHIND THE VEIL OF IGNORANCE**

# SCENARIO



## SCENARIO



**You will legislate for a new country.**

# SCENARIO

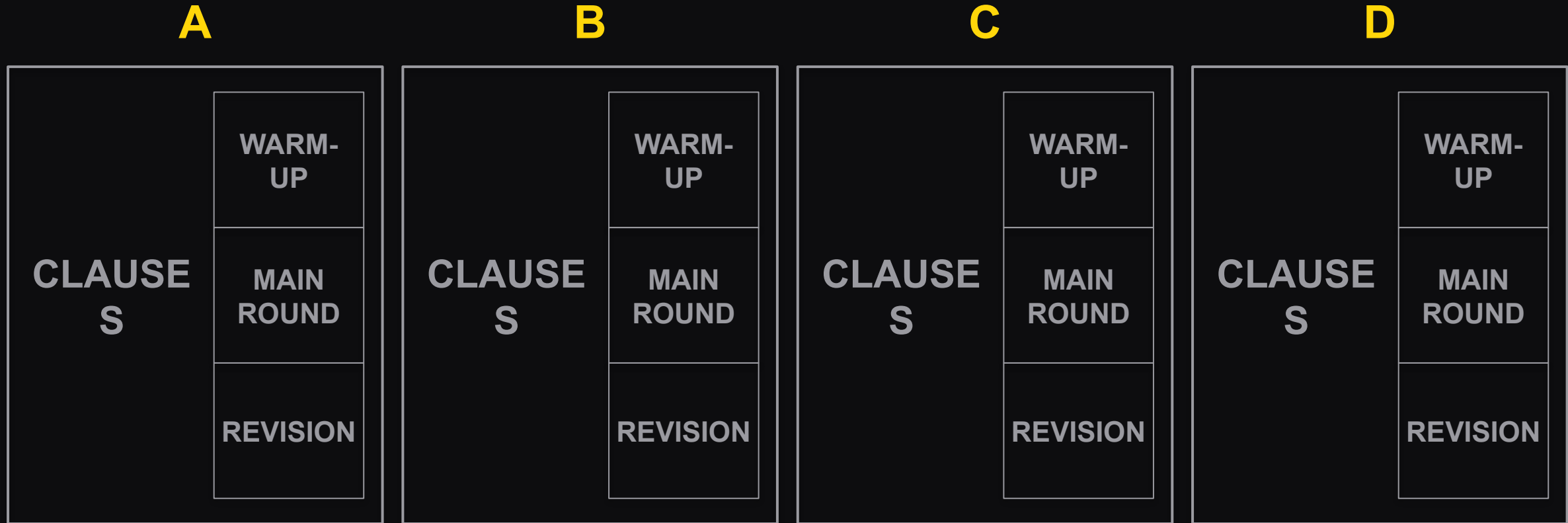
**A new country is about to be founded. It does not yet have any laws.**

**Each of the four groups is a legislature. Every group must draft a constitution.**

**The constitution has six sections: property, labour, healthcare, education, punishment, and taxation.**

## ROOM SETUP

Form four large circles of 7–8 people. Each circle corresponds to one section of the whiteboard.



**Left: write your clauses large enough for the back row to read. Three boxes on the right: record votes.**

# NUMBERING



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**Each group chooses one person. Starting with that person, count clockwise.**



# NUMBERING

**Each group first chooses one person. You will soon learn why.**

**Starting with that person, count clockwise: one, two, three ...**

**Remember your number.**

**Its meaning will be revealed only after drafting is complete.**

## MODEL CLAUSE

### SLOGAN

**Leave should be  
reasonable.**

### CLAUSES

**Each person receives at least 14 days of  
paid leave per year.  
The employer schedules it; denied leave  
must be granted later.**

**Write like the example on the right: who, how much, and who decides.**

# VIDEO DEMO



GAME

# REPUBLIC BEHIND THE VEIL OF IGNORANCE

# WARM-UP

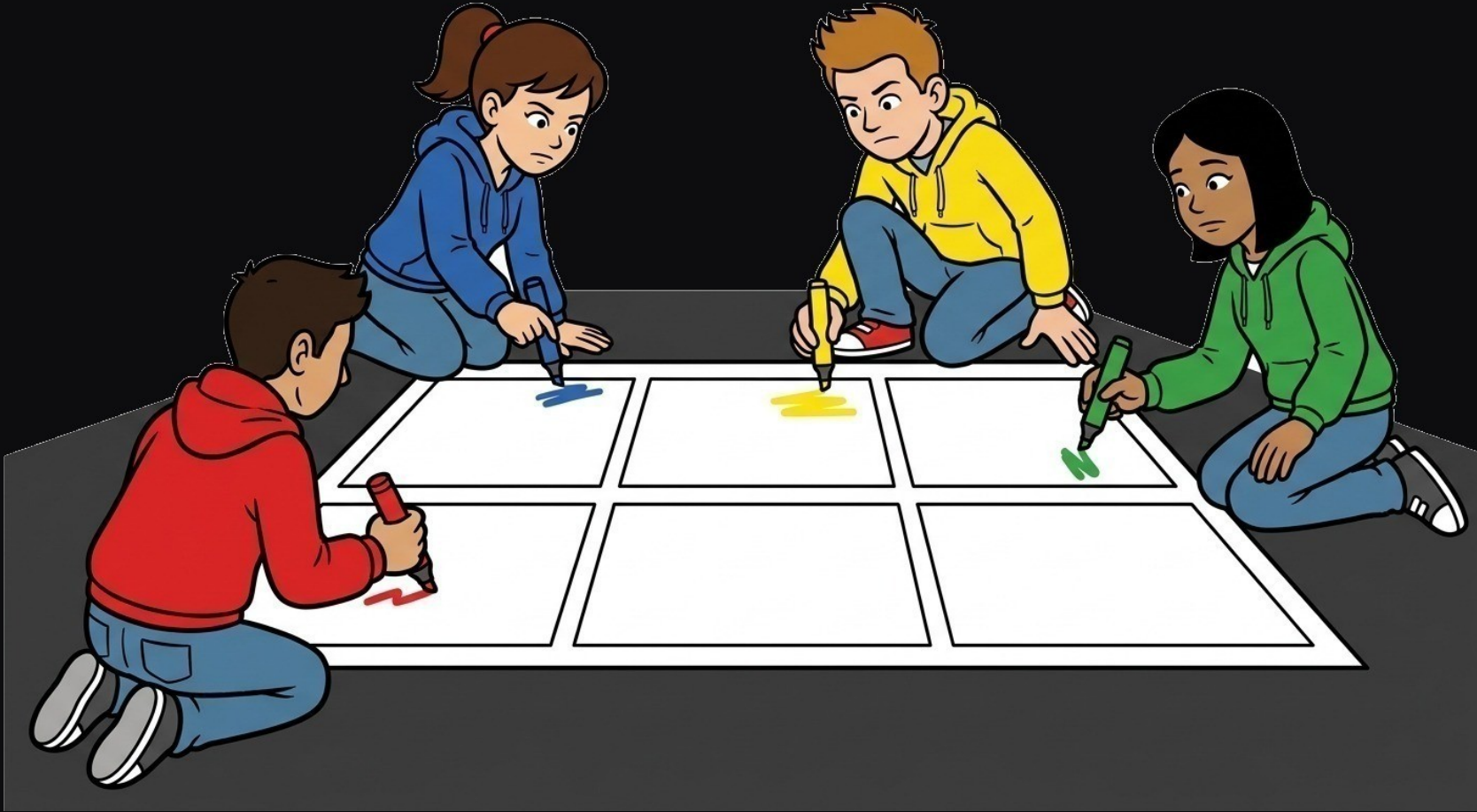


## **WARM-UP (15 MINUTES)**

- 1. Show the question. Everyone reads it.**
- 2. Each group discusses for 8 minutes and writes one clause in its whiteboard section.**
- 3. One person from each group has 3 minutes to explain the group's clause.**
- 4. Everyone votes on each group in turn: "Can you accept this clause?"  
Raise your hand if yes.**
- 5. Count raised hands; the facilitator records each total in the WARM-UP box.**

**Write large enough for the back row to read.**

## WARM-UP QUESTION



**“How many days of leave should everyone receive each year? Who decides? Are there exceptions?”**

# MAIN ROUND





## **MAIN DRAFTING (45 MINUTES)**

**Each group drafts a constitution with six sections: property, labour, healthcare, education, punishment, and taxation.**

**Each section has one question and one clause. The questions appear on the next six slides and on the front of the worksheet.**

**The six clauses must be mutually consistent: together, they form one constitution.**

**Draft on the worksheet first. Once finalised, copy the clauses to your whiteboard section in writing large enough for the back row to read.**

**Stop writing when time is called. After presentations and voting, you will have one chance to revise.**

## SECTION 1 · PROPERTY



**How far should the government go in limiting inequality of wealth?**

**Example: each person may own at most \$1 million; any excess goes to the state.**

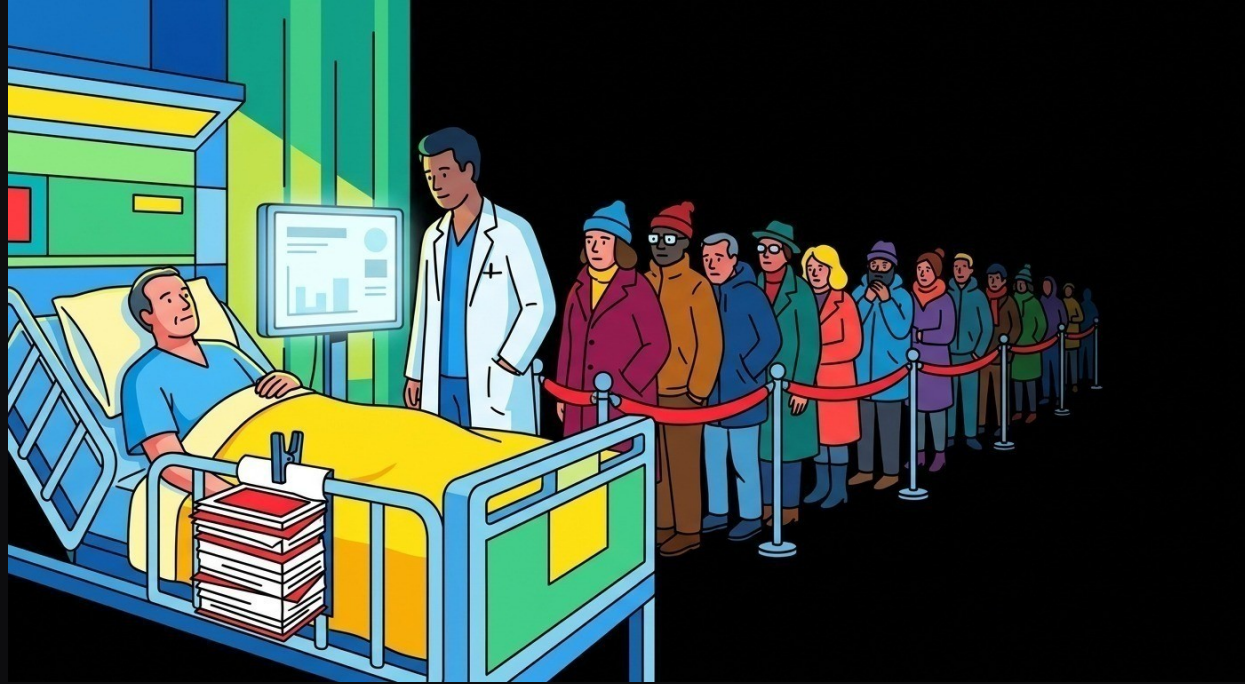
## SECTION 2 · LABOUR



**When efficiency conflicts with protection, which takes priority?**

**Example: the minimum wage is \$60 per hour, monitored by the Labour Department.**

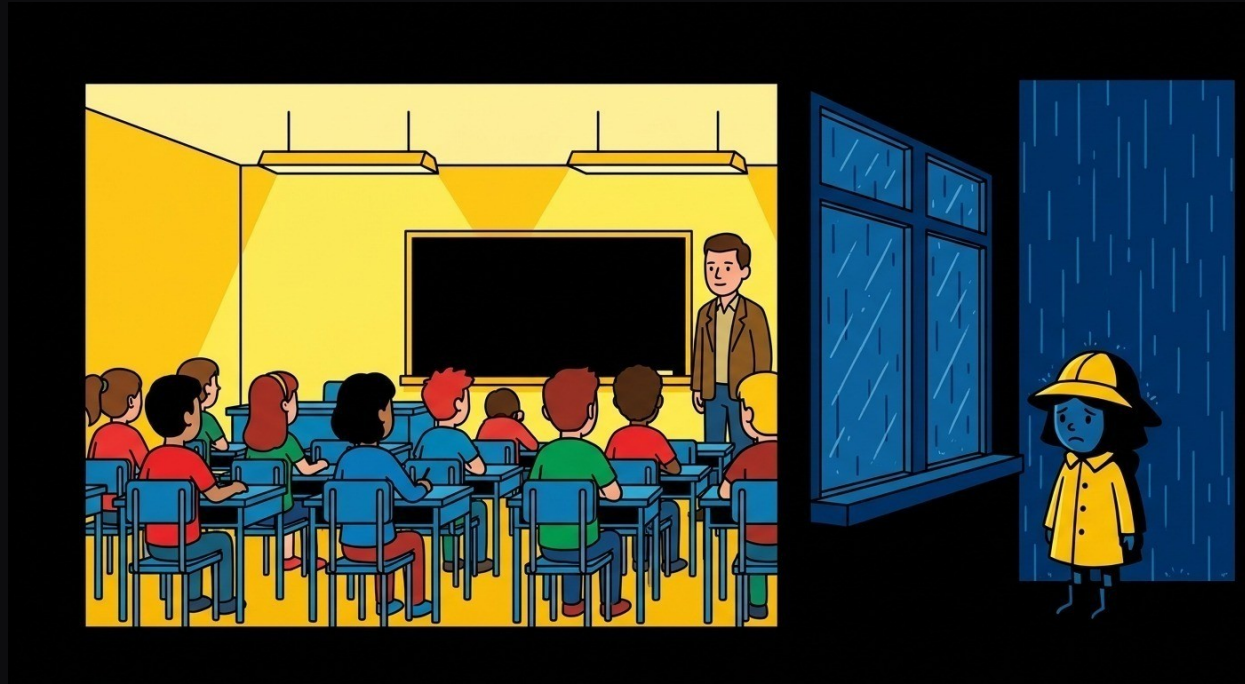
## SECTION 3 · HEALTHCARE



**Is healthcare a right or a commodity?**

**Example: public hospitals are free, funded through taxation.**

## SECTION 4 · EDUCATION



**Is education for selecting talent, or for making people equal?**

**Example: primary and secondary education are free; university is self-funded.**

## SECTION 5 · PUNISHMENT



**Is prison for punishment or rehabilitation?**

**Example: a person who steals food because of hunger receives community service instead of prison.**



## SECTION 6 · TAXATION



**Is taxing the wealthy more heavily fair, or does it punish success?**

**Example: tax rates rise with income, with brackets set by the tax authority.**

# IDENTITY





## **IDENTITY (10 MINUTES)**

**Do this step only after all clauses have been placed on the whiteboard.**

**The facilitator distributes identity cards by number. Your number determines your identity.**

**Take the perspective of the person on your card and reconsider the four constitutions.**

**Do not change any clause yet. After all presentations and voting, you will have one chance to revise.**

# PRESENTATIONS



## **ROUND PROCEDURE (ABOUT 10 MINUTES PER GROUP)**

- 1. One person presents the group's constitution and has 5 minutes to explain how it would work in practice.**
- 2. The other three groups ask questions for 3 minutes; the presenting group responds.**
- 3. Everyone votes. From the identity on your card, ask yourself:**  
  
**“Would I be willing to be born in this country?” Raise your hand if yes.**
- 4. Count raised hands; the facilitator records the total in the MAIN ROUND box.**

**GROUP 1**

**PRESENTATION · 5 MINUTES**

**QUESTIONS · 3 MINUTES**

**VOTE**

**GROUP 2**

**PRESENTATION · 5 MINUTES**

**QUESTIONS · 3 MINUTES**

**VOTE**

**GROUP 3**

**PRESENTATION · 5 MINUTES**

**QUESTIONS · 3 MINUTES**

**VOTE**

**GROUP 4**

**PRESENTATION · 5 MINUTES**

**QUESTIONS · 3 MINUTES**

**VOTE**

# REVISION





## **REVISION (20 MINUTES)**

- 1. Those who voted “no” raise a hand and identify the clause that made the country unacceptable.**
- 2. Each group hears up to three reasons, then has 10 minutes to revise its constitution.**
- 3. Mark every change on the whiteboard with a different pen.**
- 4. Everyone votes again: “Would I now be willing to be born in this country?”**
- 5. Count raised hands; the facilitator records the total in the REVISION box.**

## TWO OPTIONS

**When you face an objection, you have two options.**

**Revise the clause: you decide the objection is sound, so you change the clause.**

**Keep the clause: you decide the objection is mistaken, so you explain why it does not succeed.**

**Either counts as completion. The aim is consistency between your clauses and judgement—not universal satisfaction.**

TOTAL  
VOTES



# CONCLUSION

**Add the votes from all four sections. The group with the highest total wins.**

**Compare the MAIN ROUND and REVISION boxes. Which group gained the most votes? Which clause did it change?**

**Did any group gain votes without changing a clause? What did it say?**

**Did you change your mind? Did the clause change, or did your judgement change?**

# DEBRIEF

